17 Simulated Annealing Optimization Beyond Local Minima

This chapter covers

- Introducing simulated annealing
- Using simulated annealing to improve deliveries schedule
- A primer on the traveling salesman problem
- Using simulated annealing for minimum crossing embeddings
- An algorithm based on simulated annealing to draw graphs nicely

If you have read chapters 15 and 16, you should by now be familiar with graph embeddings and optimization problems; in the previous chapter, in particular, we have explained how to reformulate “graph embedding” as an optimization problem, and introduced *gradient descent*, an optimization technique that can be used to find (near)optimal solutions to